

08/25/26 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=978Yr9gTOAY
Publication Date	2026-08-26T09:53:12Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: August 25, 2026 (Regular Meeting)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: Statutory public hearings were conducted during the regular meeting framework rather than as a separate pre-meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer President Williams called the meeting to order [00:01:56](#), followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Peter, Mr. Irvin, Mr. What, and President Williams.
 - **Absent:** Dr. Washburn (arrived late/noted as missing initially).
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted a moment of silence and recited the Pledge of Allegiance [00:01:56](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Action consent issues (including prior minutes and standard personnel matters) were presented, moved, seconded, and approved by voice vote [00:13:42](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:13:54](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** Updated Muncie Central Athletic Handbook
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim, Mr. Walker, and Mr. Holloway.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board members discussed updates to the athletic code of conduct, which had not been revised since 2015. Key changes include integration with the "Final Forms" online registration system, modernized appeal processes mirroring school-based and employment decisions (single level of appeal from building principal to CEO Dr. Reynolds), year-round code of conduct enforcement (365 days a year), college-bound athlete and recruiting guidelines, NCC conference affiliation updates, and updated technology policies. Discussion also briefly touched upon stadium PA system issues, which leadership agreed to inspect.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:22:53](#).
- [00:28:00](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** Public Hearing on the 2027 Budget
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Droom (Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Droom presented highlights of the proposed 2027 budget, which was advertised at \$68.2 million (matching the previous year's figure). The spending is split across four funds: Education Fund (\$44.2M), Debt Service (\$10.7M), Operation Fund (\$12.6M), and Rainy Day Fund (\$612K). Budget adoption is scheduled for September 8th.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - [00:30:06](#) **Rick Yenser** (Resident/Author) commented on property tax levies, potential impacts of home destructions from recent flooding on future tax values, and noting the drop in teacher headcount alongside student enrollment figures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing held; no formal board action or vote required at this stage.
- [00:31:19](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** Public Hearing on General Obligation (GO) Bond Additional Appropriation (\$6.8 Million)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Droom.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Droom reviewed a proposed \$6.8 million GO bond to fund infrastructure improvements including roofing projects, paving, and potential LED lighting upgrades to generate operational savings. Bidding is anticipated in late Q4 2026 for execution in 2027. Repayment will occur through the debt service property tax fund.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:33:34 Rick Yenser** inquired about the relationship of this bond to previous renovation bonds and raised questions regarding fieldhouse maintenance and cooling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Public hearing closed. Motion to adopt the additional appropriation resolution was made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote **00:42:34**.
 - **00:42:50 Item Identifier & Title:** Final Bond Resolution (GO Bonds)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Droom.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the final bond resolution containing project costs, maximum interest rates, maturity dates, and approval of the registrar and paying agent.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote **00:43:31**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:08:44 Rick Yenser:** Addressed the board regarding statewide public education funding losses to charter schools, county-level income tax shifts under consideration by the legislature, and raised concerns regarding student privacy and software used to track student keyboard keystrokes. *(Note: Superintendent Dr. Reynolds later clarified via board note that the district does not utilize keystroke-tracking software 00:47:17).*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Superintendent Report (00:02:45):** Dr. Reynolds provided updates on recovery from recent community flooding, thanking maintenance/custodial staff and community/church groups for supporting families. Enrollment counts are slightly behind last year but ongoing; student support teams and community outreach liaisons are actively engaging families. Mentioned recent positive faculty kickoffs and celebrated district IE3 standardized test score gains (86% passing rate, a 6.8% growth over last year and nearly 20% increase since 2024).

- **Financial Report (00:23:06):** Mr. Droom reported July state basic grant receipts (\$3.9M), total checkbook balances exceeding \$33.5M, an education fund cash balance of over \$11.6M, a reduction in teacher headcount by 20 positions via attrition (resulting in a \$100K payroll decrease on the August 20th payroll), and a state loan balance reduced to \$4.4M following a two-year statutory extension. Financial report approved by voice vote 00:27:47.
- **Storm Recovery Recognition (00:43:57):** President Williams commended Paul Dipmier and administrative staff for tireless work mitigating damages from recent severe storms.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made, seconded, and Approved by Voice Vote 00:47:53.

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